

Youth Action Conference — Community Guidelines

Different perspectives. Shared respect. Meaningful action.

The Youth Action Conference brings together young people, speakers, facilitators, and organizations from different countries, cultures, identities, and experiences. We want YAC to be a space where people can **speak openly, listen thoughtfully, challenge ideas, ask difficult questions, and learn from one another.**

You do not have to agree with everyone. You do have to treat everyone with respect.

Our Community Commitments

-  **Respect different perspectives**
 - People will bring different beliefs, experiences, cultures, and opinions. Listen with curiosity. Disagree with ideas without attacking the person sharing them.
-  **Listen to understand**
 - Give others space to finish their thoughts. Try to understand what someone means before responding, and avoid dominating conversations.
-  **Speak with respect**
 - Challenge ideas, arguments, policies, and actions—not people's worth or identity. Harassment, bullying, threats, hate speech, discriminatory language, or personal attacks are not acceptable.
-  **Be curious, not judgmental**
 - Ask genuine questions. It is okay not to know something, change your mind, or say, *"I need to think about that."* Nobody is expected to be an expert.
-  **Make space for others**
 - Some people speak quickly; others need time to think. Some participate verbally; others may use chat, reactions, collaborative documents, or other methods. Help create space for different ways of participating.
-  **Respect privacy**
 - Do not share another participant's personal information, messages, images, contact details, or experiences outside the conference without their permission. Do not screenshot or independently record participants without permission.

-  **Take care of yourself**
 - Some YAC discussions may explore difficult global or human-rights issues. You may take a break, turn off your camera, choose not to answer a question, or leave and rejoin a session when you need to.
-  **Participate in good faith**
 - YAC exists for genuine dialogue and learning. Deliberately disrupting sessions, impersonating others, spamming, trolling, sharing deliberately harmful material, or joining to harass participants is not acceptable.

Debate Is Welcome

YAC should **not** become a place where everyone has to agree.

Participants are welcome to question an argument, offer an opposing perspective, challenge assumptions, or respectfully say:

| “I see this differently because...”

Strong disagreement can lead to excellent conversations.

However, **freedom to express an opinion does not mean freedom from being respectfully challenged**, and it does not permit harassment, discrimination, intimidation, or attacks against other participants.

Online Conference Expectations

During YAC:

- Keep your display name recognizable to conference organizers.
- Do not share conference joining links publicly or with people who have not registered.
- Camera use is encouraged where appropriate but is **not required** unless participants have been told otherwise for a specific activity.
- Use chat, microphones, reactions, and collaborative spaces responsibly.
- Do not independently record sessions or participants.
- Follow the instructions of moderators when they are managing speaking turns, breakout rooms, or sensitive discussions.
- Tell a moderator or organizer if something happens that makes you or another participant feel unsafe.

Creating an Accessible Conference

There is no single “correct” way to participate in YAC.

Participants may need to **use chat instead of speaking, keep their camera off, take breaks, have additional processing time, receive written instructions, leave and rejoin, or participate primarily by listening.**

Please respect these differences. Nobody should be pressured to explain or disclose why they need an adjustment.

Protecting Young Participants

YAC includes young people, including participants under 18.

Everyone involved in the conference is expected to maintain appropriate boundaries. Adults and older participants should be particularly mindful of the responsibility that comes with participating in a youth-centered space.

Participants should not use YAC to solicit inappropriate private contact, sexual or romantic interactions, financial transactions, or other relationships that could place a young participant at risk.

If an interaction concerns you, contact a YAC organizer rather than trying to investigate or resolve a safeguarding concern yourself.

If Something Goes Wrong

If you experience or witness behavior that does not meet these guidelines, **tell a YAC host, moderator, or designated safeguarding contact.**

You can raise a concern during the conference or privately afterward.

Depending on the situation, organizers may:
remind → warn → restrict participation → remove

Serious behavior may result in immediate removal from the conference. Where there is a safeguarding or safety concern, organizers may also need to take additional appropriate action.

People who raise concerns in good faith should not be targeted or retaliated against.

Challenge ideas. Respect people.

YAC works when everyone can bring their perspective to the conversation while helping others do the same.

Be curious. Be courageous. Make space. Take action.